Weddings, by the lake.

AN INQUIRY PACK FOR THE YEAR AHEAD

> *A 100-year-old secret on Gates Lake, 45 minutes from Whistler. The whole property — seven cabins, the Meeting Hall, the lake-view deck, and the dock — yours for a weekend.*

A FEW WORDS FIRST

A wedding that feels like you.

If you've made it this far, you're probably tired of the same five wedding venues coming up in every search. We get it. Birken isn't trying to be one of them.

We're a 100-year-old resort on Gates Lake — a quiet, turquoise gem tucked between the Coast Mountains, about 45 minutes north of Whistler. Seven historic cabins, a lake-view Meeting Hall, a dock that catches the morning light just right, and a kitchen run by chefs who know what local food actually tastes like.

What we offer for weddings is simple: the whole place. For a weekend, it's yours. Your people in the cabins. Your ceremony at the lake. Your reception in the Meeting Hall. Your morning after at the Grille, slow coffee, lake still, no rush to leave.

> *No ballroom carpet. No banquet manager in a vest. No "preferred vendor" list of forty. Just the lake, the cabins, your people, and a team who's done this before.*

QUICK FACTS

7	32	120	45min
CABINS	SLEEPS ON-SITE	EVENT CAPACITY	FROM WHISTLER

WHAT'S INCLUDED

The whole property, yours.

A Birken wedding isn't a venue rental. It's a full-property buyout — every cabin, every space, every corner of the resort, exclusively yours from check-in Friday to check-out Sunday.

ACCOMMODATION — SEVEN CABINS

- **The Wild West** · *Sleeps 6 · the original 1906 log cabin, lake view, wood-burning stove*
- **The Bunk House** · *Sleeps 8 · the group hub, full kitchen, bar area*
- **The Chapel** · *Sleeps 4 · the only cabin with a private washroom — often the bridal suite*
- **Mexico Cabin** · *Sleeps 4 · large porch, outdoor dining patio, lake view*
- **The Library** · *Sleeps 3 · the quiet one, large private deck, full bookshelf*
- **Love Shack** · *Sleeps 2-4 · raised king, wood-burning fireplace, intimate*
- **Moroccan Cabin** · *Sleeps 2 · the smallest, the most charming, a quiet escape*

SPACES & GROUNDS

- **The Meeting Hall** · *indoor reception space, light-filled, modern finishes*
- **The lake-view deck** · *panoramic views over Gates Lake — most ceremonies happen here*
- **The private dock** · *swimming, photos, golden hour, first looks*
- **Communal fire pits** · *for the rehearsal night and the after-party*
- **The grounds** · *full property exclusivity — no other guests for the weekend*
- **Parking** · *on-site, free, accommodates the full guest list*

THE PACKAGES

Three ways to gather.

Every wedding here is a full-property buyout — that part doesn't change. What flexes is the size, the catering scope, and how much you'd like us to handle. Three tiers, three weekends, one lake.

TIER ONE · INTIMATE

The Lakeside

Up to 40 guests. A small ceremony, a long-table dinner, and the people you actually want there.

INCLUDES

2-night buyout (Fri–Sun) · all 7 cabins · Meeting Hall · lake-view deck · ceremony coordination · welcome basket per cabin · firewood & basic setup

FROM

$11,500

+ catering · taxes

TIER TWO · THE WEDDING VILLAGE

The Full Weekend

Up to 80 guests on-site, 120 for the ceremony & reception. The classic Birken weekend — most couples land here.

INCLUDES

3-night buyout (Thu–Sun) · all 7 cabins · Meeting Hall · lake-view deck · ceremony & reception coordination · rehearsal dinner space · welcome basket per cabin · vendor liaison · firewood & full setup

FROM

$16,000

+ catering · taxes

TIER THREE · EXTENDED

The Long Weekend

A 4-night takeover. For couples who want a true destination weekend — welcome dinner Thursday, recovery brunch Monday.

INCLUDES

4-night buyout (Thu–Mon) · everything in Tier Two · welcome dinner at the Grille · Sunday recovery brunch · extended vendor support · activity coordination (lake, hikes)

FROM

$22,000

+ catering · taxes

A NOTE ON PRICING

All packages are starting points. Final pricing is shaped by date (peak summer carries a premium), guest count, catering scope, and add-ons. Long-weekend dates and statutory holidays are priced separately. We'll quote your specific weekend in your inquiry response.

A TYPICAL WEEKEND

From Friday to Sunday.

Every wedding shapes itself differently — but here's how a typical Tier Two weekend tends to unfold. Treat this as a starting point, not a script.

FRIDAY · AFTERNOON	**Arrival & check-in** Couples arrive first to settle into the Chapel or chosen suite. Cabins open at 4pm — the wedding party fans out across the property. Welcome baskets in each cabin.
FRIDAY · EVENING	**Rehearsal dinner** Most couples host a rehearsal dinner at the Meeting Hall or around the fire pit. Catering can be arranged through us or your chosen caterer. Lake swim optional, encouraged.
SATURDAY · MORNING	**Slow morning, getting ready** Coffee at the Grille, breakfast in cabins. The bridal party often takes over the Chapel; the groom's party tends toward the Bunk House. No rush — the day is yours.
SATURDAY · AFTERNOON	**Ceremony at the lake-view deck** Most ceremonies happen on the deck overlooking Gates Lake — typically 4pm or 5pm to catch the light. Indoor backup at the Meeting Hall in case of weather.
SATURDAY · EVENING	**Reception, dancing, fire** Reception in the Meeting Hall — long tables, lake light, a dance floor. The party tends to spill out to the fire pits as the night softens. No noise curfew, within reason.
SUNDAY · MORNING	**The slow goodbye** Brunch at the Grille (or in cabins). One last swim. Photos at the dock. Check-out 10am — though most weddings linger past that, and we're flexible.

THE PRACTICAL STUFF

Honest answers to real questions.

How far in advance should we book?

Most peak-summer weekends (June–September) book 12–18 months out. We're currently taking 2027 inquiries, with a small handful of 2026 dates still open.

Do you have a preferred vendor list?

We have trusted local florists, photographers, and officiants we love working with — but you're free to bring your own. We'll provide a list of recommendations once you book.

What about catering?

Our Lakeside Grille team can cater on-site, or you can bring in an external caterer of your choice. Most couples mix both — we handle rehearsal & brunch, an external caterer handles the reception.

Is the venue accessible?

The Meeting Hall has a wheelchair ramp and accessible entry. The grounds are largely flat with some uneven natural surfaces. The cabin washrooms (except the Chapel's) do not have ramps — we can talk through specific access needs.

Pets at the wedding?

Yes — we're pet-friendly. Dogs are welcome in cabins and at the ceremony with prior arrangement.

What's the deposit and payment schedule?

A 20% non-refundable deposit secures your date. The remaining balance is due 90 days before the wedding.

Cancellation policy?

Written notice 90+ days out: 80% of the original booking amount returned. Inside 90 days: the full balance remains due. We strongly recommend wedding insurance.

What happens if it rains?

The Meeting Hall is your indoor backup for ceremony and reception. We'll plan both options with you — most BC summer weddings here have used the deck, but the indoor space is genuinely beautiful.

Can guests stay in the cabins?

Yes — all 7 cabins are part of the buyout. Our on-site sleeping capacity is around 32. For larger guest counts, we can recommend nearby accommodation.

Are kids welcome?

Absolutely. Children under 5 stay free; older kids are billed at the standard $25 extra-guest rate. Many of our weddings are happily multi-generational.

FROM HERE

Let's pick a weekend.

> If this feels right, here's how the next few weeks tend to unfold. No pressure, no aggressive follow-up — just a conversation.

1. **Tell us about your weekend**
   Email or call us with your date(s), guest count, and a few words about the wedding you're picturing. The more we know, the better we can tailor the response.

2. **We'll send a tailored quote within 24 hours**
   Specific to your date, guest count, and chosen tier. Honest pricing — what's included, what's optional, what we'd recommend.

3. **A site visit, if you'd like**
   Most couples come out for a half-day visit before booking. We'll walk the property, talk through ideas, and make you a coffee.

4. **Hold the date with a 20% deposit**
   Once you're in, we'll send a contract, take the deposit, and the date is yours. From here, we'll connect you with our trusted vendor list.

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LOOKING FORWARD TO HEARING ABOUT YOUR WEEKEND.